



C7_News articles on science

Objectives and
structure

News articles

- In the 'science' news; still *news*!
- Journalistic language – persuasive, attention grabbers, etc
- 'News' structure of information
- The purpose of a news article is to communicate new/established knowledge in fields to non-specialists (popularization of science)
- It's not first hand information but rather 'second hand' – that is, it has already been 'digested' and interpreted for the reader by the journalist and then provided to the end user, the reader.

News article – case study

- [C7 worksheet 1](#) (text online or in C7_worksheet 2)
- Graded assignment (1.5p)

The language of news/journalism vs the language of science

C7 Worksheet 3



Aspect observed	News article	Research article
Speech	Dialogue (direct)/indirect speech	Dialogue (direct)/indirect speech
Tenses		
Passive/active voice verbs		
Choice of vocabulary		
Validation of claims		

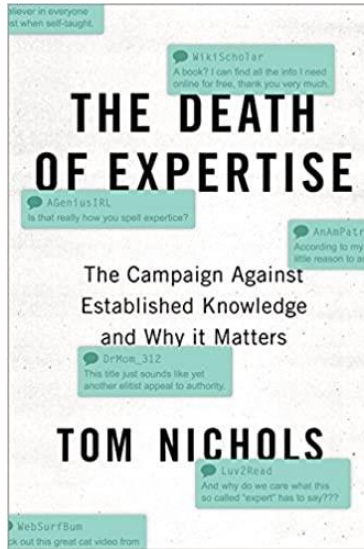
The language of news/journalism vs the language of science (key to previous slide)

Aspect observed	News article	Research article
Speech	Dialogue (quotation) +indirect speech	Only indirect speech/reported
Tenses	Present continuous – to show sth is in development right now, in progress – the audience feels they are witnessing the events	No present continuous Just simple pres, pres perfect and past tense
Choice of words	<i>To broadcast for to show</i> – more dramatic	<i>emotion recognition</i> – technical/scientific vocabulary Formal language
Passive/active voice verbs	Avoids passive verbs	Prefers passive verbs for impersonal style;
Validation of claims	By direct speech of an authority	By reviewing items of literature and comparing own results with previous research

Why?

Technology and increasing levels of education have exposed people to more information than ever before. These societal gains, however, have also helped fuel a surge in narcissistic and misguided intellectual egalitarianism that has crippled informed debates on any number of issues. Today, everyone knows everything: with only a quick trip through WebMD or Wikipedia, average citizens believe themselves to be on an equal intellectual footing with doctors and diplomats. All voices, even the most ridiculous, demand to be taken with equal seriousness, and any claim to the contrary is dismissed as undemocratic elitism. (Tom Nichols, The Death of Expertise, 2017)

Knowledge vs
information



Understand
the true
value of
info
=
Expert
consumer
of info

Expert knowledge vs
layman's opinion

